Getting Started

Mission Trips helps organizations run short-term mission trips. Organizations publish trips, people create an account and apply, staff review and approve applications and organize rooms and flights, and friends and family donate toward a participant's costs. The system emails participants along the way.

This guide covers accounts, signing in, the menu bar, and the conventions every screen shares. Each role's guide then describes its screens field by field.

Who uses Mission Trips

Role	What they do
Trip Participant	Applies to trips, keeps their profile and documents up to date, follows their next steps, and donates.
Pending User	Someone staff added to an organization who hasn't been given another role yet. They see the same pages as a Trip Participant.
Trip Leader	Runs the trips they lead: applications, documents, team roles, rooming, flights, donations, and team emails.
Org Admin	Runs one organization: its people, trips, worker roles, document types, medical conditions, email templates, and pictures, plus everything a Trip Leader does on its trips.
Agent	A travel agent who books flights for an organization's trips.
System Admin	Runs the whole system: every organization and the shared lists (airports, airlines, email types, and email tokens).
Donors and visitors	Anyone can view an organization's public trip pages and donate without an account.

One person can have different roles in different organizations. Trip Leader and Trip Participant can also be given for one trip only.

Creating an account

There are two ways to create an account.

From the sign-in page

1. Open the Mission Trips site. The sign-in card is titled **Mission Trips**.
2. Choose **Add person / create account**. The card changes to **Create account**.
3. Fill in the form (fields below) and choose **Create account**. You're signed in right away.

Field	What to enter
First name	Required.
Middle name	Optional here, but a complete profile needs it before you can submit an application.
Last name	Required.
Preferred name	The name you go by. It fills in as "First Last" until you type in it, and is saved as "First Last" if left blank. Include a suffix such as M.D. or R.N. if appropriate.

Email	Required. This is the email you sign in with and the one emails are sent to.
Password	Required. At least 8 characters.
Confirm password	Type the password again.
Organizations (optional)	Pick the organizations you want to join. You join each one as a Trip Participant. You can leave it empty.

If you opened the site at your organization's own web address, the **Organizations** field is replaced by a "Joining *organization name*" note, and you join that organization automatically.

From an Apply button

On an organization's public trip page, **Apply** opens a page titled **Apply with *organization name*** (or **Apply for a trip**):

- **Add a new account if you don't have one** opens **Add a new account**. It has the same name, email, and password fields as above (no organization list). You join the organization you came from as a Trip Participant and land on the trip's page, ready to apply.
- If you already have an account, sign in under **Log in to your account** with **Email** and **Password** and choose **Log in**.
- **← Back to trips** returns to the organization's public trip list.

If the email already has an account, **Add a new account** shows "This email already has an account" with a **Go to log in** button, and the sign-in page shows "An account with this email already exists. Please log in instead."

If an organization emailed you an invitation, its **Create account** link opens the form with your email and name already filled in.

Signing in and out

- On the **Mission Trips** card, enter **Email** and **Password** and choose **Sign in**.
- You stay signed in for 4 hours.
- Each device signs in separately. Signing out on your phone doesn't sign you out on your computer.
- After 5 wrong passwords in a row, your account is locked for 15 minutes. You can wait, or reset your password to unlock it right away.
- To sign out, open the user menu (the circle with your initials at the top right) and choose **Log out**.

Forgot your password?

1. On the sign-in page choose **Forgot password?**. The email you typed is carried over.
2. On **Forgot password**, check **Email** and choose **Send reset link**. You'll always see "If an account exists for that email, we sent a link to reset your password. The link expires in 1 hour."
3. Open the emailed link ("Reset your Mission Trips password"). On **Reset password**, enter **New password** (at least 8 characters) and **Confirm password**, then choose **Reset password**.
4. You return to the sign-in page with "Your password has been reset. Please sign in."

Resetting your password signs you out on every device. Only the newest link works, each link works once, and you can request at most 3 reset emails an hour. If a link has expired, choose **Request a new link**.

Changing your password

1. Open your profile: **Profile** in the menu bar, or **Edit profile** in the user menu.
2. Under **Personal details**, choose **Change password**.
3. Fill in the **Change password** dialog and choose **Save**.

Field	What to enter

Current password	Your password today.
New password	At least 8 characters.
Confirm new password	The new password again.

Only you, or a System Admin, can change your password or the email you sign in with. An Org Admin can't change them for you.

The menu bar

The menu bar runs across the top of every page once you're signed in. Its color follows the selected organization's **Color family**.

- **Home icon** (the organization's logo, or a house): goes to Home.
- **Title:** the selected organization's name ("Mission Trips" when none is selected; "Mission Trips Admin" for a System Admin viewing all organizations).
- **Menu items:** the buttons below. You only see the ones your role allows.
- **Organization selector:** see Choosing an organization.
- **User menu:** the circle with your initials. See The user menu.

Menu reference

Menu item	Opens	Who sees it	Described in
Dashboard	Home	Everyone	Each role's guide
Profile	Your **Edit profile** dialog: personal details, health, documents	Trip Participants and Pending Users. Staff use **Edit profile** in the user menu instead.	Participant guide
People	The **People** list: everyone in the organization, with **Add person** and **Email**	Org Admins, System Admins	Organization admin guide
Organizations	The **Organizations** list and organization settings	Org Admins (their organization), System Admins (all)	Organization admin guide
Document types	The kinds of documents people upload, and their rules	Org Admins, System Admins	Organization admin guide
Email types	The shared list of what each email is about	System Admins	System admin guide
Email tokens	The shared list of fill-in values for emails	System Admins	System admin guide
Airports	The shared airport list	System Admins	System admin guide
Airlines	The shared airline list	System Admins	System admin guide

Trips (for Org Admins and System Admins)	The **Trips** list: every trip in the organization	Org Admins, System Admins	Organization admin guide
Trips (for Trip Leaders)	The **Trips** page: the participants of the trips you lead	Trip Leaders who aren't Org Admins	Trip staff guide
Donations	The **Donations** page for a trip	Org Admins, System Admins, approved Trip Leaders, approved Trip Participants	Trip staff guide
Templates	The **Email templates** list	Org Admins, System Admins, approved Trip Leaders	Organization admin guide
Pictures	The organization's picture library for emails	Org Admins, System Admins	Organization admin guide
Worker roles	The jobs on a team, such as Nurse, and the documents each needs	Org Admins, System Admins	Organization admin guide
Medical conditions	The organization's list of medical conditions	Org Admins, System Admins	Organization admin guide

Agents see only **Dashboard**. They reach a trip's **Flights** page from Home.

Choosing an organization

Most staff pages work on one organization at a time.

Selector	Who sees it	Choices	What it does
Organization	Anyone (except System Admins) who belongs to more than one organization	Your organizations, alphabetically. An Org Admin sees only the organizations they administer. Others see every organization where they have a role, or an approved trip role.	Switches every page to that organization. Your last choice is remembered.
Emulate org	System Admins	**All organizations**, then every organization	Shows the system as that organization. **All organizations** removes the filter; pages that manage one organization's lists then ask you to pick one.

The user menu

Choose the circle with your initials at the top right. It shows your full name and email, then:

- **Edit profile** opens your own profile. It shows when your account is linked to a person record.
- **Log out** signs you out on this device.

How screens work

These conventions apply on every page.

- **Dates** show as MM/DD/YYYY, and times as h:mm AM/PM. An empty value shows "—".

- **Money** shows as $1,234.50. In a money field, a "$" shows while you type and the amount is formatted when you leave the field. A zero or unreadable amount shows "Enter a valid amount".
- **Row actions** are small icon buttons at the end of each table row (for example a pencil to edit, an eye to view, a red trash can to delete). Hover over one, or tab to it, to see its name.
- **Tables** sort when you click a column header, and show 10 rows per page with page controls at the bottom. An empty table says "No data available" unless the page gives its own message.
- **Confirmations** open a box titled "Are you sure?" with the action named in the message. Choose the confirm button to go ahead, or the other button (**No** or **Cancel**) or the Esc key to back out.
- **Required fields** show a message under the field, or at the top or bottom of the dialog, when you try to save without them.
- **Someone else saved first.** If another person changed the same record while you were editing, you'll see "This data has changed since it was loaded. The latest data has been reloaded. Review your changes and save again." Make your changes again and save.
- **Phone numbers** have two fields: a country code (for example +1; the "+" is added for you) and the number, formatted as (555) 555-5555 as you type. If you fill in one, you must fill in the other.
- **Addresses** start with **Country** (United States first, then every country alphabetically). For the United States, **State** is a list of the 50 states, District of Columbia, and US territories. For other countries it's a **State / province** text box.
- **Pictures** you upload (profile photos, logos, trip images) can be PNG, JPEG, GIF, WebP, or HEIC, up to 2 MB.
- **Documents** you upload can be PDF, JPG, PNG, or HEIC (iPhone photos), up to 10 MB.